INCH-POUND
A-A-2845
October 4, 1994

# COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

## SHEARS; GRASS CUTTING AND HEDGE TRIMMING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description (CID) as a replacement for Federal Specification GGG-S-280 for all federal agencies.

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This commercial item description covers grass and hedge shears.

## 2. CLASSIFICATION

2.1 Classification. The shears shall be of the following types, as specified:

Type I - Grass-cutting
Type II - Hedge-trimming

## 3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

3.1 Blades. Blades shall be manufactured from heat-treated carbon steel, high strength low-alloy steel, or corrosion-resisting steel. The cutting edge of each blade shall be uniformly ground throughout its cutting length and sharpened ready for service. The blades shall be pointed. The outer surfaces of the blades shall be flat, beveled, or oval shaped, at the option of the manufacturer. The blades shall be heat treated to a hardness of Rockwell C 43 to 60 when tested in accordance with ASTM E18.

3.2 Handgrips. Metal, fiberglass, or plastic handgrips, where specified, shall be free from burrs, fins, seams, rough edges, and sharp corners. Wood handgrips, where specified, shall be sound, well-seasoned hardwood. The blade ends of wood grips shall have a metal ferrule.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, Engineering Group (7FXEE). 819 Taylor St., Fort Worth, TX 76102



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3.3 Finish. All metal surfaces, except blades, shall have a painted, plated, lacquered, or enameled finish. Metal handgrips shall be plated, anodized, or have a painted finish. Wood handgrips shall be smooth and shall have an applied coating of varnish, lacquer, or polyurethane. Carbon steel blades shall be coated or plated with a protective coating such as black oxide, chrome plating, polytetrafluoroethylene, or similar material.

3.4 Identification marking. The shears shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark. The use of an adhesive-backed label shall be acceptable.

3.5 Type I. grass-cutting shears. The type I shears shall have a draw-type action whereby one blade moves toward and across the other stationary blade. The shears shall be equipped with an opening spring, positive stop(s) , and locking device. A pressure plate or similar device shall be used to keep the blades from separating under heavy pressure. The shears shall be similar to Figure 1 and comply with the following dimensions:

Length of cut: 4 to 6-1/4 inches (101.6 mm to 158.8 mm)
Blade width: 3/4 inch minimum (39.1 mm)
Blade thickness: 0.070 inch minimum (1.8 mm)
Overall length: 12-1/4 to 14-3/4 inches (311.2 mm to 374.7 mm)

The blades shall operate in a manner such that there is no excessive looseness, sideways movement, or binding when shears are opened or closed during the-cutting operation.

The handgrips shall operate in an up and down motion at right angles to the cutting-plane of the blades. The handgrips shall be manufactured from a suitable metal, fiberglass, or plastic.

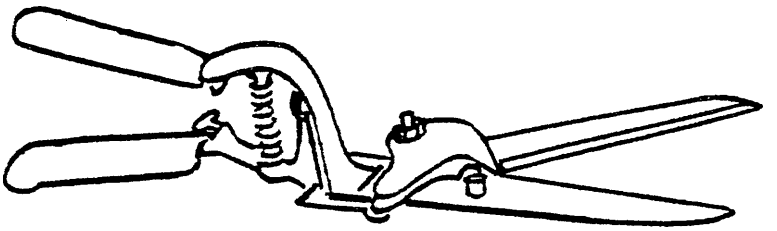

Figure 1

Metal handgrips shall be covered with a vinyl, plastic, or rubber cushion. The spring shall be suitable for the purpose intended. The locking device shall be capable of locking the blades in the closed position. The closing of the shears shall be limited by means of either integral or external stop(s).

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3.6 Type II. hedqe-trimming shears. The type II shears shall have a scissors-type action whereby both blades move equally toward (or from) a centerline which bisects the angle of the opposing blade. The blades shall be integral with the shanks of the handgrips. The shears shall be similar to Figure 2 and comply with the following dimensions:

Length of cut: 7 to 10-1/4 inches (177.8 mm to 260.4 mm)
Blade width: 1-1/8 inch minimum (28.6 mm)
Blade thickness: 0.125 inch minimum (3.2 mm)
overall-length: 20 to 27 inches (508.0 mm to 685.8 mm)

The shears shall have either one plain blade and one serrated blade or two plain blades. The shears shall have a cutting notch for pruning heavy branches. The shears shall be joined by means of a steel bolt in a manner such that there is no excessive looseness, sideways movement, or binding when shears are opened or closed. The bolt shall not be less than 0.372 inch (9.5 mm) diameter and shall have a threaded steel nut.

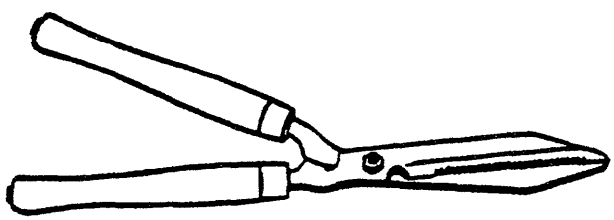

Figure 2

The handgrips shall operate in a sideways motion when held parallel to the ground. The handgrips shall be manufactured from either tubular steel, aluminum, fiberglass, hardwood, Or Combination thereof. Metal handgrips shall have a rubber/plastic cushion on the actual handgrip portion of the handle. Wood handgrips may have rubber/plastic cushions on the handgrips at the manufacturer's option. Wood handgrips shall have a minimum diameter of 1 inch (25.4 mm) and a minimum length of 9 inches (228.6 mm). Handgrips other than wood may have a minimum diameter of 7/8 inch (22.2 mm) provided handgrip cushions are present. The thickness of the handgrip shall not include the cushion thickness. The handgrips shall be securely attached to the tang end of the shank by means of rivets, nail pins, or a bolt. The closing of the shears shall be limited by means of either integral or external stop(s). The shears shall be equipped with a shock absorbing device or cushion bumper(s).

3.7 Workmanship The shears shall be free from ragged edges, cracks, holes, pits, and other defects which would affect the appearance and serviceability of the item.



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3.8 Metric products Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within tolerances specified and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

3.9 Standard commercial product l The shears shall, as a minimum, be in accordance with the requirements of this cid and shall be the manufacturer’s standard commercial product. A standard commercial product is a product which has been sold or is currently offered for sale on the commercial market through advertisements, manufacturer's catalogs, or brochures, and represents the latest production model.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

4.1 Recovered materials. The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

5.1 Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer’s own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

6. PACKAGING

6.1 Preservation, packing, and marking. Preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES

7.1 Sources of documents.

7.1.1 Sources of non-Government association documents.

ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM), 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.



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7.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents (if applicable).

a. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
b. Type required.
c. The preservation, packing, and marking required.

7.3 Figures. The figures shown herein are descriptive and not restrictive, and not intended to preclude the purchase of shears which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this commercial item description.

7.4 National Stock Numbers (NSN's): The following is a list of NSN's assigned which correspond to this commercial item description. The list may not be indicative of all possible NSN's

| NSN | Type | Nomenclature |
|---|---|---|
| 3750-00-165-4133 | I | Shears, Grass Cutting |
| 3750-00-951--1585 | XI | Shears, Hedge Trimming |

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodian
Air Force - 99

Review Activity
Air Force - 84

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
GSA - 7FXEE



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